



Nigeria Artificial Intelligence Industry Collective

NIGERIA AI COLLECTIVE COMMUNITY MONTHLY DIGEST

INDIA AI IMPACT SUMMIT 2026 SPECIAL EDITION

This Month's Highlights:

Nigeria AI Collective Amplifies National AI Ecosystem at India AI Impact Summit	Google & Ipsos
Report: 93% of Nigerians Leverage AI for Complex Learning and Skill Development	Nigerian AI
Startup 'Decide' Secures 4th-Place Global Ranking for Spreadsheet AI Accuracy	NITDA and Wigwe
University Forge Strategic AI Partnership to Drive Innovation in Agriculture and Tech	AI Integration
Spurs CAC to Process 10,000 Business Registrations Daily, Transforming Entity Onboarding	Kasi
Cloud's Hyperscale AI Data Campus Takes Shape in Lagos, Paving the Way for Local AI Infrastructure	
Introducing WAXAL: Africa's Large-Scale Open Speech Dataset Powering Inclusive Voice AI Innovation	
Moonshot AI Introduces Kimi K2.5: Open-Weight AI with Advanced Vision and Multi-Agent Capabilities.	

Papers

Improving BGE-M3 Multilingual Dense Embeddings for Nigerian Low Resource Languages	Accent-Aware Text-to-Speech for Nigerian English: Building Inclusive Voice AI from Community-Curated Data
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Opportunities

Ericsson's NextGen Hackathon	Turing AI Global Fellowships	AI for Good Impact Awards
ARISE Project 2026 PhD Scholarships and Postdoctoral Fellowships in AI	Call for Papers - IndabaX	
Climate Investment Challenge	Google for Startups Accelerator Africa	IBM Impact Accelerator

Upcoming Events

AI Nexus: The Future of Work with Digital Tools	Conference - BellsTech Centre for Artificial Intelligence	AI Conference and Expo - Nvidia
UPSCALE Conference 4.0	Pie & AI: Abuja - AI for All	

Thoughtful Leadership

Nigeria's Strategic Presence at India AI Impact Summit 2026



The India AI Summit brought together over 200,000 participants, including president of nations, ministers, multilateral leaders, and global technology from across the globe. Nigeria's participation at the India AI Impact Summit 2026 in New Delhi was strategic, coordinated, and aimed at advancing national priorities within the global AI ecosystem. Nigeria's presence was not symbolic; it was a deliberate effort to assert voice, visibility, and influence in shaping AI policy and development.

At the heart of Nigeria's engagement was the Nigeria AI Collective Global Breakfast Meet-Up, which brought together members of the Nigerian AI community from across geographies for a focused and forward-looking exchange.

The meet-up created a structured yet informal space to reaffirm a central message: Nigeria's AI ambition is global, and so must be its collaborations. The session reinforced the importance of aligning innovation, policy, and ecosystem building across borders. Through a roundtable dialogue, participants shared how to strengthen cross-border collaboration within the Collective. Conversations centred on practical mechanisms for sustained engagement, diaspora participation, and inclusive representation across the ecosystem. The session concluded with shared reflections on the future of the community, reinforcing a collective commitment to building a globally connected, nationally impactful AI movement.

A Pavilion That Commanded Attention

Nigeria's presence on the exhibition floor was purposeful and strategic. The Nigeria AI Collective had its own dedicated stand at the Summit, serving as the national hub for Nigerian innovations and providing a unifying platform for ecosystem actors to showcase solutions, engage delegates, and coordinate outreach. At the AfricaAI Village and broader expo, Nigerian innovators were among the select African startups and solution providers presenting their work to global delegates. Coverage of the event confirms that the following Nigerian organisations participated and demonstrated their AI-enabled solutions:



EqualyzAI: Building inclusive AI tools tailored to Africa's diverse language communities, with a focus on hyperlocal datasets and language models that understand and process African languages.



mDoc: A digital healthcare pioneer focused on remote care and patient-provider connectivity, using AI-enabled systems to improve access to health services, especially in underserved areas.



UDU TECHNOLOGIES

Udu Technologies (UduTech): Positioned as a trusted AI partner helping governments, enterprises and large institutions translate AI ambitions into real-world solutions, with technology designed for enterprise-level workflows and public-sector applications.

These companies showcased services and tools aligned with real-world use cases, from multilingual and inclusive AI systems to AI-assisted healthcare and enterprise solutions, aimed at addressing context-specific challenges in Africa, rather than abstract or purely conceptual offerings.

The Pavilion drew high-level international attention. Delegates from multiple continents engaged with exhibitors to explore partnerships, investment opportunities, technology exchange, and collaborative research. Notable visitors included the Italian Minister of ICT, reinforcing Nigeria's growing relevance in cross-border AI collaboration.

Through structured demos, stakeholder meetings, and engagement sessions, the Pavilion emphasised the coordinated nature of Nigeria's AI ecosystem. It demonstrated the practical application of AI across sectors such as healthcare, language accessibility, enterprise digitisation, and public services, and highlighted how the Collective is fostering alignment between policy, innovation, and capacity-building.

Major Declarations, Partnership and Investments at the AI Summit



The AI Impact Summit in New Delhi culminated in the adoption of the New Delhi Declaration, a multilateral framework backed by 88 countries committing to inclusive, development-centred artificial intelligence. Positioned within India's broader "Pax Silica" vision, the declaration prioritises open innovation, digital public infrastructure, trusted AI governance and Global South collaboration.

On the investment front, the headline figure was over \$250 billion mobilised for AI and digital infrastructure across the Global South, a decisive pivot from dialogue to deployment.

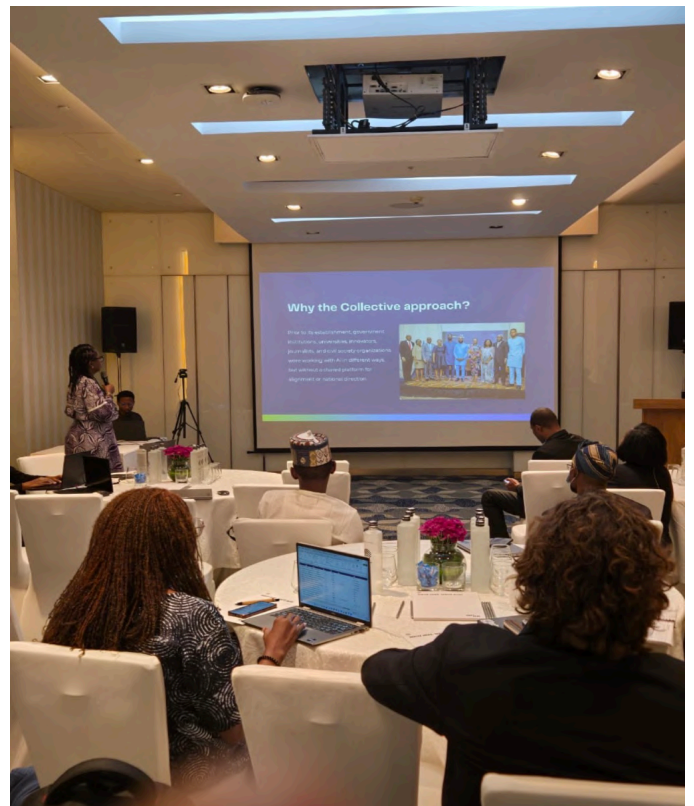
Microsoft committed \$50 billion by 2030 to expand cloud and AI infrastructure in emerging markets, alongside skilling 20 million people globally. Reliance Jio outlined \$110 billion to drive affordable AI services at scale. Adani Group pledged \$100 billion towards green data centre infrastructure, while Qualcomm announced \$150 million to support AI start-ups across growth markets. Complementing private capital, the Government of India signalled institutional muscle with a \$1.1 billion AI venture fund, \$20 billion for deep-tech development, and access to 20,000 GPUs to expand compute capacity.

For Nigeria, the signal is clear: the centre of gravity in AI is shifting towards infrastructure-backed execution, with capital, compute, energy and skills converging at unprecedented scale.

Some photos from the Summit

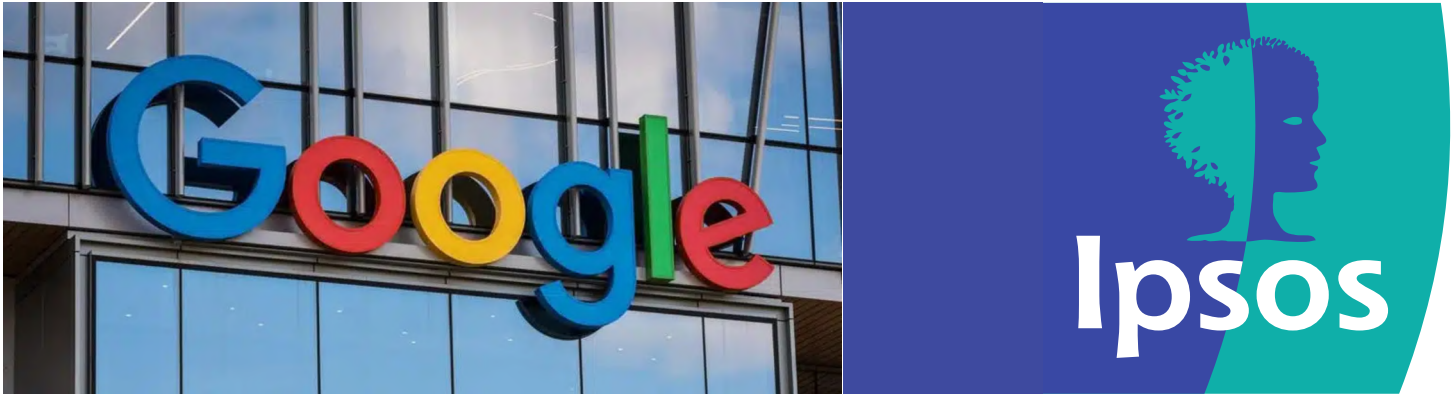






Google & Ipsos Report: 93% of Nigerians Leverage AI for Complex Learning and Skill

Development



A new global study by Google in partnership with Ipsos, *Our Life with AI: Helpfulness in the Hands of More People*, reveals that Nigeria stands out not only for its high rate of artificial intelligence adoption but also for how purposefully the technology is being used across daily life, education and work. The survey, conducted in late 2025 among roughly 1,000 Nigerian adults, shows that AI is no longer treated as a novelty but is being actively used to solve real problems and support ambition.

One of the most striking findings is that 93% of Nigerian respondents report using AI to help them learn or understand complex topics, a figure that far exceeds the 74% global average. This suggests that AI tools are being leveraged as study aids and cognitive partners, assisting learners in breaking down difficult concepts and bolstering comprehension. Similarly, adoption of AI chatbots in Nigeria at 88% is significantly higher than the global average of 62% and marks an 18-point increase over the previous year. This rapid uptake reflects both growing familiarity with AI interfaces and confidence in their value for everyday tasks.

The workplace is another area where AI is rapidly shifting from optional to essential. According to the report, 91% of Nigerian adults use AI to support their job functions, indicating that the technology is being integrated into routine work tasks and used to augment productivity rather than merely for observation or curiosity. Moreover, around 80% of respondents employ AI to explore new business ideas or consider career changes, nearly double the global average of 42% underscoring its role in entrepreneurship and economic mobility.

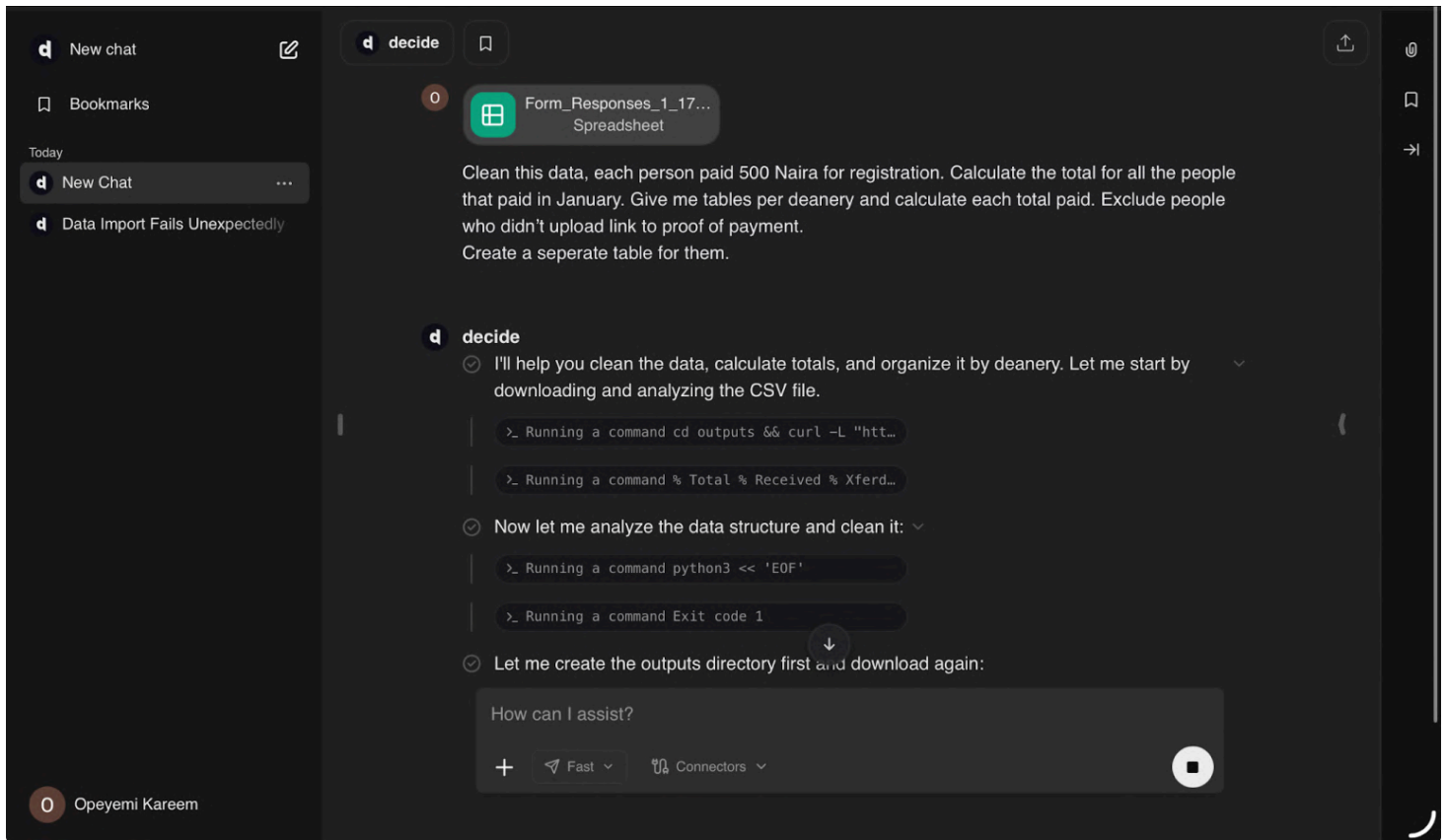
Nigerians also exhibit unusually high optimism about the impact of AI on learning and education. About 91% believe AI is having a positive effect on how people learn and access information, compared with roughly 65% globally, and 95% say university students and educators are likely to benefit significantly from the technology. These figures point to a broad sense that AI can democratise access to knowledge and support academic achievement.

Finally, the overall sentiment towards AI in Nigeria is significantly more positive than in many other parts of the world. Around 80% of Nigerian respondents say they are more excited than concerned about the possibilities of AI, while only 20% express greater concern, a contrast with more divided global opinion. Among frequent users, this excitement rises to 90%, suggesting that hands-on experience with AI tends to breed confidence rather than fear.

Taken together, the report's findings depict a national environment in which AI is deeply embedded into how people learn, work and pursue economic opportunity. Rather than being confined to speculative or recreational use, AI in Nigeria is increasingly treated as a practical and empowering tool with real-world benefits.

Nigerian AI Startup 'Decide' Secures 4th-Place Global Ranking for Spreadsheet AI

Accuracy



In benchmark-driven AI research, Nigerian startup 'Decide' has gained international recognition by ranking fourth globally on SpreadsheetBench, a widely referenced benchmark for AI performance on real-world spreadsheet tasks. SpreadsheetBench evaluates how well AI agents handle complex spreadsheet environments, including multi-sheet workflows, formulas, spatial layouts and multi-step reasoning, rather than simplified table questions.



Decide, founded by ex-Flutterwave developer Abiodun Adetona, achieved an accuracy score of 82.5 per cent, correctly solving 330 out of 400 tasks in the benchmark's Verified subset.

Only three AI agents: (Nobie Agent, Shortcut.ai and Qingqiu Agent) ranked higher, placing Decide in the same performance band as systems backed by major global AI labs and well-funded startups.

Decide was initially built to reduce the time professionals spend cleaning data, debugging formulas and moving across multiple Excel sheets, and now serves more than 3,000 users, including paying customers, only months after public launch. The product does not simply suggest formulas but interprets the structure of spreadsheets, executes changes and explains its actions in natural language.

Adetona frames the SpreadsheetBench result as proof that focused engineering and domain-specific AI can produce frontier-level performance outside large research organisations. For the wider African ecosystem, Decide's ranking strengthens the argument that African AI companies can compete on deep technical benchmarks, not only in locally bounded applications, provided there is sustained investment in applied research and product iteration.

NITDA and Wigwe University Forge Strategic AI Partnership to Drive Innovation in Agriculture and Tech



The National Information Technology Development Agency (NITDA) and Wigwe University took concrete steps towards a strategic AI collaboration covering research, agriculture and digital talent. In a meeting in Abuja, Wigwe University's Vice-Chancellor, Professor Marwan Al-Akaidi, and senior NITDA officials agreed to lay groundwork for a partnership that aligns academic ambition with Nigeria's national technology mandate.

The collaboration is framed explicitly around building a locally driven Nigerian AI that reflects domestic needs, languages and realities, rather than relying solely on imported systems.

NITDA officials highlighted existing platforms such as the National Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Robotics and the National Adopted Village for Smart Agriculture as key anchors where joint projects with Wigwe University can plug in.

Wigwe University is being positioned as an advantage for AI-enabled agriculture and food systems research. The institution has signalled plans to apply AI across livestock management, land-use optimisation, food processing and agricultural productivity, using Nigeria's large cattle population as a reference point for how technology and better feeding systems could unlock higher yields.

Healthcare is also on the agenda, with Professor Al-Akaidi pointing to AI's potential in diagnosis and management of diseases such as malaria. Both NITDA and Wigwe University agreed to establish dedicated contact teams and map specific workstreams in AI research, agricultural innovation, virtual learning, digital literacy and curriculum development, signalling intent to move quickly from concept to implementation.

AI Integration Spurs CAC to Process 10,000 Business Registrations Daily, Transforming

Entity Onboarding



In Nigeria's corporate regulatory space, the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) reported that it now processes close to 10,000 business registration requests daily following the full deployment of AI across its service platforms. This marks a dramatic increase from the hundreds of registrations that were handled in earlier years when processes were manually driven and centralised.

Registrar-General Hussaini Magaji linked the surge in registrations to AI-enabled efficiency, tax reforms and policies encouraging the formalisation of informal enterprises, alongside rapid growth in digital and social-media-based businesses. He added that CAC's systems now also manage around 5,000 customer enquiries daily through emails and call centres, volumes that would be difficult to sustain without automation.

The AI rollout at CAC has not been frictionless: officials acknowledged that the transition to an AI-driven portal caused temporary disruptions and productivity setbacks in 2025. However, the commission now presents itself as a fully digital, end-to-end corporate registry operating 24/7 and serving both domestic and international users.



New AI tools on the redesigned CAC website include an AI legal assistant that responds to regulatory queries and an AI-powered business name generator that helps entrepreneurs create and reserve compliant business names. These features, combined with targeted initiatives such as free business-name registrations for thousands of small businesses, situate AI as a practical lever for improving the ease of doing business and accelerating formalisation.

Kasi Cloud's Hyperscale AI Data Campus Takes Shape in Lagos, Paving the Way

for Local AI Infrastructure



Kasi Cloud's hyperscale AI data campus in Lekki, Lagos, is emerging as one of the most consequential bets on Nigeria's digital future. The company is building what it describes as Nigeria's first data-centre campus purpose-built for AI, spread across approximately 42 hectares near the Lagos-Calabar coastal road.

Nigeria currently has around 17 operational data centres, none with capacity above 20 megawatts, whereas the Kasi campus is engineered for up to 100 megawatts of installed capacity dedicated to AI and high-density compute workloads.

The first six-storey building on the site is designed to deliver 32 megawatts across four data-hall floors, with an initial 5.5 megawatts expected to go live around April 2026 before being upgraded to the full 8 megawatts on that floor.

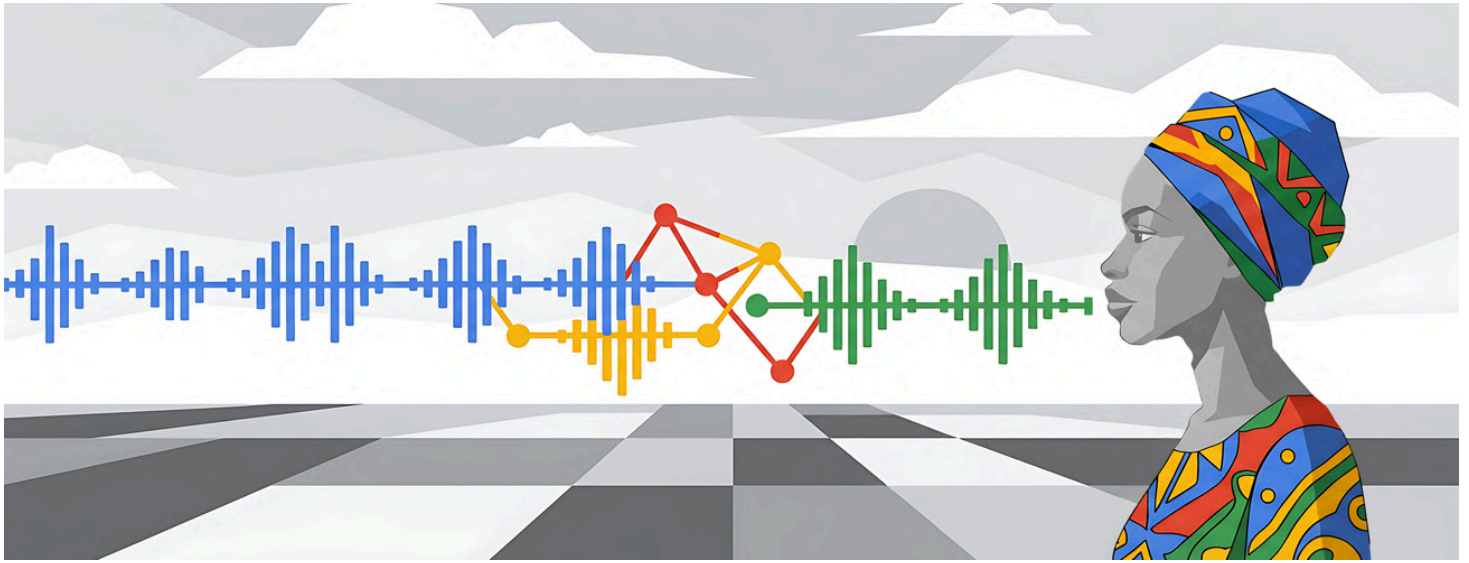
Kasi Cloud's founder and CEO, Johnson Agogbua, stresses that the facility is not a retrofit but has been designed "for AI from day one", with rack power densities ranging from 10 to 100 kilowatts to accommodate GPU-heavy systems that define modern AI workloads. This design contrasts with many existing Lagos data centres optimised for 5 to 10 kilowatts per rack, which struggle to accommodate the thermal and power demands of current-generation AI hardware.

Ground was broken on the roughly 250-million-dollar project in April 2022, with construction starting in the second quarter of 2023 and commercial operations for the first phase targeted for the second quarter of 2026. As global AI campuses race past the 50-megawatt mark, the Kasi project signals an intent to ensure that Nigerian AI companies and public institutions can access high-density local compute rather than depending solely on offshore capacity.



Introducing WAXAL: Africa's Large-Scale Open Speech Dataset Powering Inclusive

Voice AI Innovation



In February 2026, Google Research Africa, together with a consortium of African universities and community partners, unveiled WAXAL a large-scale, open-access speech dataset aimed at expanding voice-enabled artificial intelligence across the continent. The initiative addresses the longstanding scarcity of high-quality speech data for African languages, a gap that has historically excluded millions of people from voice-based technologies.

Developed over three years with funding and technical support from Google, WAXAL aggregates more than 11,000 hours of speech recordings, including approximately 1,250 hours of transcribed natural speech for automatic speech recognition and over 20 hours of studio-quality recordings for building natural-sounding synthetic voices.

The dataset covers 21 Sub-Saharan African languages, among them Hausa, Yoruba and Igbo; three of Nigeria's most widely spoken indigenous languages alongside languages such as Swahili, Luganda and Acholi. By providing foundational data for these languages, WAXAL lays the groundwork for developers to build voice assistants, transcription tools and accessibility technologies that work robustly in the vernaculars of millions across West and Central Africa.

What sets WAXAL apart is its collaborative, community-first model. Rather than outsourcing data collection to external contractors, Google's partners including Makerere University in Uganda, the University of Ghana and Digital Umuganda in Rwanda, led the data gathering efforts and retain ownership of the material they contributed. This partnership-led approach ensures that the dataset reflects authentic speech patterns and supports ethical engagement with language communities.

Aisha Walcott-Bryant, Head of Google Research Africa, framed WAXAL not simply as a resource but as infrastructure for inclusive innovation: a platform that equips African students, researchers and entrepreneurs with the tools to create technology "in their own languages, on their own terms," and to reach more than 100 million people previously underserved by voice AI.

Early feedback from academic partners highlights how access to high-quality speech data is already stimulating research and applications across sectors such as education, healthcare and agriculture. For audiences in West Africa, including Nigeria, the availability of Hausa, Yoruba and Igbo speech data represents a significant step towards breaking down barriers in voice technology and widening participation in the AI economy.



Kimi K2.5 represents a decisive step forward for open-weight frontier AI, extending the Kimi series into multimodal reasoning, ultra-long context processing and large-scale agent orchestration. Developed by Moonshot AI and officially released on January 27, 2026, the model is designed to compete directly with leading proprietary systems while remaining openly accessible to developers and enterprises. Built on an approximately 1-trillion-parameter Mixture-of-Experts (MoE) architecture with about 32 billion active parameters per token, Kimi K2.5 combines scale with computational efficiency. It supports context windows of up to 512,000 tokens, enabling sustained reasoning across entire books, codebases, policy archives or multi-document research workflows. Pretrained on roughly 15 trillion mixed text-and-vision tokens, it integrates a native vision encoder, allowing it to interpret images and video alongside text.

What distinguishes K2.5 is not only its scale, but its orchestration capabilities. Its “agent swarm” system can dynamically spin up and coordinate up to around 100 specialised sub-agents, executing as many as 1,500 parallel tool calls for complex tasks such as large-scale code refactoring or distributed web research. This parallelism significantly reduces wall-clock time compared to traditional single-agent reasoning chains, shifting the model from passive response generation toward active task execution.

The model operates in both “instant” and “thinking” modes, powering the Kimi chatbot, API services and developer tools such as Kimi Code. It is positioned for real-world applications including software development, long-form document analysis, report and slide generation, multilingual research synthesis and automation workflows.

Performance benchmarks place Kimi K2.5 among the strongest open-weight models available, particularly in coding and multimodal evaluation suites. On Humanity’s Last Exam, it achieves approximately 50% when equipped with tools, and it records mid-70% scores on SWE-Bench Verified, bringing it close to top proprietary coding-focused systems.

Strategically, Kimi K2.5 continues the trajectory set by earlier iterations such as Kimi K2 and Kimi K2 Thinking, pushing open-weight models closer to the frontier traditionally dominated by firms like OpenAI, Anthropic and Google. By releasing both weights and code publicly, Moonshot AI positions the model as infrastructure for enterprises, researchers and builders seeking custom multimodal agents, visual analysis systems or on-premise deployments.

Home-grown Research with Global Recognition

Paper: [Improving BGE-M3 Multilingual Dense Embeddings for Nigerian Low Resource Languages](#)

Authors: Abdulmatin Omotoso, Habeeb Shopeju, Adejumobi Monjolaoluwa Joshua, Shiloh Oni

In *Improving BGE-M3 Multilingual Dense Embeddings for Nigerian Low-Resource Languages*, the authors improve the performance of a popular multilingual embedding model, BGE-M3, on three major Nigerian languages: Yorùbá, Igbo, and Hausa.

Dense embeddings are numerical representations of text that help machines understand meaning across languages, which is key for tasks like search or question answering. The team curated a large dataset from news and community sources for each language and paired these with equivalent English queries to enable cross-lingual training.

Using this dataset, they applied contrastive fine-tuning to optimize BGE-M3 specifically for these low-resource languages. The result was significant improvements in search quality: when tested, the fine-tuned model ranked correct responses much higher compared to the original baseline across all three languages.

The paper not only advances technical performance for these languages but also demonstrates a practical pathway for inclusive AI research; by collecting and aligning real-world language data and adapting existing multilingual models through targeted training, language technology can serve communities that mainstream AI often overlooks.

Paper: [Accent-Aware Text-to-Speech for Nigerian English: Building Inclusive Voice AI from Community-Curated Data](#)

Authors: Christianah Oyewale, Benjamin Ogbonna

In this work, Christianah Oyewale and Benjamin Ogbonna present a voice-technology system specifically tailored to Nigerian-accented English, addressing a common shortfall in mainstream speech AI, which often fails to reflect the rich accent diversity found in emerging markets.

The researchers built a community-curated dataset by recording speakers from Nigeria's three major ethnic groups (Yoruba, Igbo, and Hausa) reading a range of texts on topics like history, politics, and education. After careful transcription and segmentation, the dataset resulted in over 4,000 paired audio-text samples that capture authentic Nigerian speech patterns.

Using the StyleTTS2 architecture and phoneme-level processing, the model learns to generate speech that reflects both accent characteristics and expressive qualities such as pitch and prosody. At inference time, the system can produce new speech outputs in a chosen speaker's style when given a text input.

Human evaluation showed that approximately 87 % of synthesized outputs were rated as faithful to the intended accent and natural in tone, while model intelligibility, measured by Word Error Rate averaged about 12.4 % across test samples, indicating good clarity and usability.

This paper highlights how locally sourced data and community participation can significantly improve voice AI performance for under-represented language varieties, with broad potential applications in education, accessibility, public services, and speech-based interfaces across Africa.

Opportunities and Events

An overview of upcoming events, available funding, proposal invitations, and other timely opportunities shared within the Community.

Ericsson's NextGen Hackathon



A national innovation challenge by Ericsson, the Nigerian Government, and Tech Revolution Africa that empowers students, startups, and young innovators to build solutions in AI, 5G, IoT, and cloud. Participants receive mentoring and an 8-week acceleration program, with top teams gaining access to funding, incubators, and global exposure.

Deadline – 10th March 2026

Turing AI Global Fellowships



A prestigious research fellowship funded by the Engineering and Physical Sciences Research Council (EPSRC) and UK partners for exceptional AI researchers based outside the UK. It offers up to £4.5 million over 5 years to relocate to a UK host institution and lead world-class AI research, building a strong research team and advancing foundational or interdisciplinary AI work. Applicants must work with an eligible UK research organisation to submit a proposal.

Deadline – 12th March 2026

ARISE Project 2026 PhD Scholarships and Postdoctoral Fellowships in Artificial Intelligence (AI)



The ARISE Project

The ARISE Project (Advancing Responsible and Gender-Inclusive AI Capacity in Africa's Higher Education Ecosystem) by the African Technology Policy Studies Network (ATPS) is offering fully funded PhD scholarships (10 awards) and postdoctoral fellowships (6 awards) for Africa-based researchers working on responsible, ethical, and gender-inclusive AI across key sectors like agriculture, climate change, health, education, and digital economy. Awardees receive research funding, stipends, mentorship, and opportunities to attend international AI conferences.

Deadline – 10th March 2026 (PhD Scholarships) 31st March 2026 (Post Doc Scholarships)

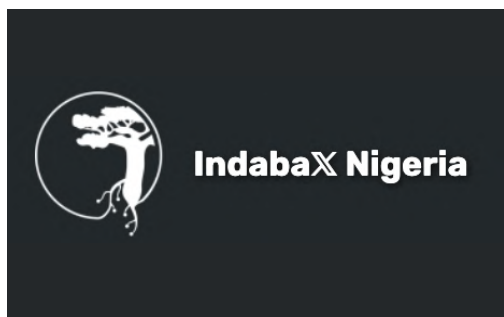
AI for Good Impact Awards



A global awards programme organised by the International Telecommunication Union (ITU) that recognises AI solutions with real-world impact. The awards highlight innovative projects in three categories: AI for People (improving community well-being), AI for Planet (environment & sustainability), and AI for Prosperity (economic resilience & innovation) with winners honoured at the AI for Good Global Summit in Geneva. Submissions must show measurable societal, environmental, or economic benefits.

Deadline – 15th March 2026

Call for Papers - IndabaX Nigeria 2026



The Nigerian edition of the Deep Learning Indaba (IndabaX Nigeria), a premier continental AI and machine-learning gathering has opened its Call for Papers and Posters for researchers, practitioners, and community builders to submit their work for presentation at the event, which takes place 11–14 May 2026 at the University of Ibadan. This is a great opportunity to share AI research, insights, applications, and case studies with a growing pan-African AI community.

Deadline – 15th March 2026

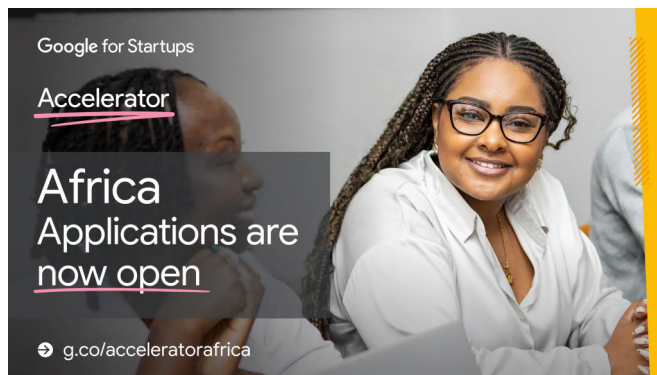
Climate Investment Challenge

**CLIMATE
INVESTMENT
CHALLENGE**

A global innovation competition inviting postgraduate teams to design finance-ready solutions that unlock and scale climate investment, either through innovative financing mechanisms or data-driven climate analytics. Winning teams can receive cash prizes (total ~£16,000 – £24,000), mentorship, and access to a climate finance network, with finalists pitching to experts in London. Concept note submissions are due 16 March 2026, with the final event in June 2026.

Deadline – 16th March 2026

Google for Startups Accelerator Africa 2026



A 12-week AI-First hybrid accelerator by Google for Startups for growth-stage African tech startups building AI and machine-learning-enabled solutions. Selected founders get equity-free support, personalized mentorship from Google engineers, access to cutting-edge AI tools and Google Cloud credits, and networking opportunities.

Deadline – 18th March 2026

IBM Impact Accelerator

Let's power learning that shapes tomorrow's workforce.

IBM Impact Accelerator

A global social innovation programme by IBM that offers two-year, pro-bono support (AI tech, cloud services, and expert mentorship) to nonprofits, government agencies, and academic institutions developing AI-powered solutions that strengthen education, career pathways and workforce readiness. The current RFP is open until 25 March 2026, inviting proposals for projects that use AI to help people learn more effectively, transition into jobs, and navigate the changing labour market. Selected organisations gain access to IBM platforms like watsonx, IBM Cloud, AI models, and consulting expertise.

Deadline – 25th March 2026



Upcoming Events

An overview of upcoming events, available funding, proposal invitations, and other timely opportunities shared within the Community.

AI NEXUS The Future of Work with Digital Tools

Implementation • Prompting • Real Workflows

 Saturday,
7th March 2026

 Oriental Hotel,
Victoria Island, Lagos

 Physical (Limited seats)
+ Virtual Access

www.thetechfeast.com

AI Nexus is a practical workshop focused on how professionals and business owners can apply AI tools in their daily work. The session covers workflow automation, productivity strategies, and hands-on AI tool usage, with actionable takeaways for immediate implementation. Ideal for beginners and non-technical participants looking to build real-world AI skills.

Date: 7th March 2026

Venue: Lagos Oriental, Lagos



Bells University of Technology, Ota Nigeria
in collaboration with
Faculty of Engineering, SRM
Institute of Engineering and Technology, India

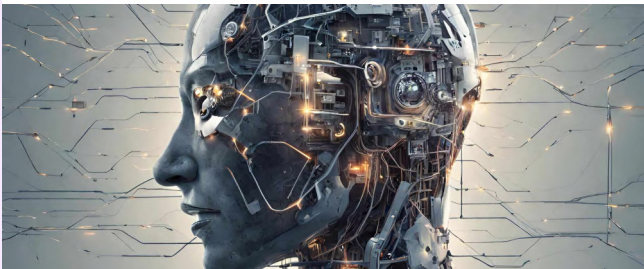
hosts

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE ON INTELLIGENT SYSTEMS AND
RESPONSIBLE AI: ENGINEERING THE FUTURE ACROSS DOMAINS
(ICISRAI 2026)

www.aicentre.bellsuniversity.edu.ng/conference/

FINAL CALL FOR PAPERS

THEME: EXPLORING THE POTENTIALS OF INTELLIGENT SYSTEMS AND
ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE ACROSS MULTI-DISCIPLINARY FIELDS

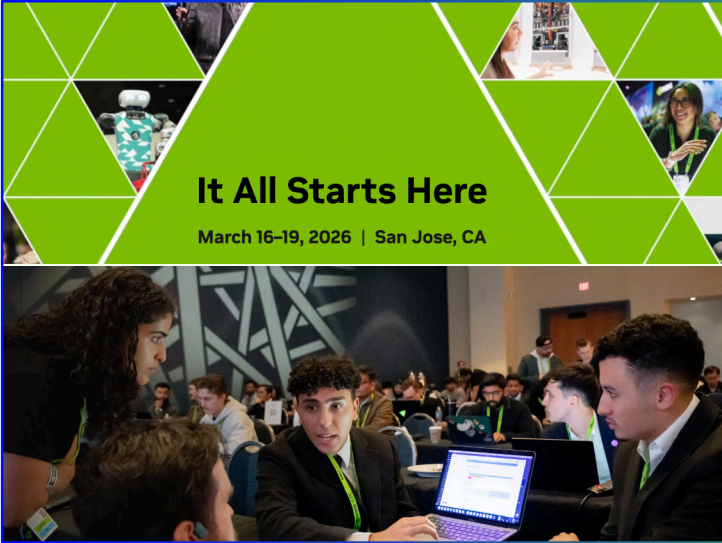


The International Conference on Intelligent Systems & Responsible Artificial Intelligence (ICISRAI 2026), hosted by BellsTech Centre for Artificial Intelligence at Bells University of Technology, Ota, in collaboration with SRM Institute, India, convenes academics, researchers, industry, and policymakers. This hybrid event explores responsible AI in smart healthcare, sustainable agriculture, autonomous systems, NLP, cybersecurity, industrial automation, and ethical governance, fostering collaboration on local and global AI challenges.

Date: 16th - 18th March 2026

Venue: Bells University of Technology, Ota, Nigeria





NVIDIA's annual AI Conference & Expo (GTC)

brings together developers, researchers, startups, and enterprise leaders to explore the latest breakthroughs in AI, accelerated computing, robotics, and generative AI. The event features keynotes, technical sessions, hands-on workshops, and product announcements, making it a valuable opportunity to stay current with global AI trends and innovations.

Date: 16th – 19th March 2026

Venue: San Jose, CA



Upscale Conference 4.0 is a forward-looking gathering focused on AI, innovation, and the future of work. The event brings together founders, professionals, policymakers, and tech enthusiasts to explore how emerging technologies are shaping business, careers, and economic growth in Nigeria. It's a strong networking and ecosystem-building opportunity for the AI community.

Date: 21st March 2026

Venue: Abuja, Nigeria



Pie & AI is a community-focused event aimed at making AI accessible to everyone. It highlights how innovation, talent development, and AI opportunities can intersect to drive growth, offering sessions, networking, and practical insights for both beginners and professionals looking to engage with Nigeria's AI ecosystem.

Date: 28th March 2026

Venue: Abuja, Nigeria

Thought Leadership



Dr. Olubayo Adekanmbi

CEO Data Science Nigeria

Spoke on Nigeria's Presence at the India AI Impact Summit:

"Nigeria's active presence at the Global AI Summit in India signals far more than participation; it reflects intention, capability, and ambition. Our innovators did not just showcase solutions at the AI Village or speak on global stages; we came together as a nation, home and diaspora, to reflect on the progress of our National AI Strategy and chart the next phase of execution through the National AI Collective platform."

In the panel session he joined, he spoke with urgency and conviction, framing what he described as the critical architecture for national progress: "the interlock between DPI and AI." With clarity, he asserted that "while DPI makes it possible, AI makes it personal," challenging policymakers to move "from the registry mindset that DPI provides to the relationship mindset that AI makes possible." His call to action was direct, government must "move from being an operator to becoming a facilitator" and "make the infrastructure available, allow the private sector to build on it." The crescendo was unmistakable: "DPI gives us the rail. But AI gives us the trail. And it is that trail that gives the value... the economy a multiplier effect." (February 2026)

Read more: [Premium Times](#)



Osasuyi Dirisu

Executive Director, Policy Innovation Centre (PIC)

"The summit provided a structured platform for global engagement. What matters now is whether Nigeria becomes a meaningful contributor to global AI evolution. That will depend less on visibility abroad and more on coordinated execution at home." (February 2026)

Read more: [Premium Times](#)



Yetunde Anibaba

Professor at Lagos Business School and Accreditation Lead (LBS)

She warned against fragmented progress for Nigeria regarding AI during the India AI Impact Summit:

"It is once again clear that Nigeria cannot afford to misuse this AI moment. Without a cohesive and systemic approach, we risk becoming known not for meaningful progress, but for fragmented investments."
(February 2026)

Read more: [Premium Times](#)



Akintunde Babatundes

Executive Director, Centre for Journalism Innovation and Development (CJID)

"The 2026 Global AI Summit may have taken place thousands of kilometres away, but stakeholders say its implications are domestic. Whether Nigeria becomes a meaningful contributor to global AI evolution will depend less on visibility abroad and more on coordinated execution at home." (February 2026)

Read more: [Premium Times](#)



Nerandra Modi

Prime Minister of India

"At a defining moment in human history, the world gathered at the AI Impact Summit 2026 in New Delhi... We must ensure AI serves humanity, not the reverse." (19 February 2026)

Read more: [PMINDIA](#)



Yann LeCun

AI Godfather, AMI Labs/NYU

"I think the most interesting thing that we're going to build is an amplifier for human intelligence... AI is going to be our staff... Long term it's going to come from countries that have favourable demographics, and that means India, Africa." (February 2026)

Read more: [DQINDIA](#)



Brad Smith

Microsoft Vice Chair

"AI usage in the Global North is roughly twice that of the Global South and this divide continues to widen... AI skills are foundational to ensuring that AI expands opportunity." (February 2026)

Read more: [BUSINESS-STANDARD](#)



Ade Famoti

Microsoft Research Translation Leader

Praised Africa's visibility via Africa AI Village and Nigeria AI Collective: "It was a personal highlight engaging with founders and researchers advancing frontier AI work from Nigeria and across the continent." (February 2026)

Read more: [Linkedin](#)



Yann Antonio Guterres

UN Secretary-General

Announced independent AI scientific panel, noting governance lags AI's pace. (February 2026)

Read more: [economictimes](https://www.economictimes.com)



Yoshua Bengio

AI Godfather, Co-President and Scientific Director of LawZero

"Adapting foreign models is not enough. Countries need to build their own AI systems that reflect their values, languages, and priorities." (February 2026)

Read more: [moneycontrol](https://www.moneycontrol.com)



Ashwini Vaishnaw

Indian IT Minister

"The numbers are important, but what truly matters is that the world has confidence in India's role... through innovation that doesn't require the largest budgets—it requires the smartest approaches." (February 2026)

Read more: [timesofindia.indiatimes](https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com)

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